



1866

FYODOR DOSTOYEVSKY PUBLISHES CRIME AND PUNISHMENT

One of the greatest works of Russian literature, *Crime and Punishment* explored the psychology of crime, guilt, and redemption through the story of impoverished murderer Raskolnikov. It drew on Dostoyevsky's own experiences in a Siberian prison camp.

◁ *Crime and Punishment*, first edition cover

1865

15 April 1865
US President
Abraham Lincoln
dies after being shot

1867 AUSTRO-HUNGARIAN EMPIRE FORMED

After a series of foreign policy failures and military defeat by Prussia, Austria's Franz Joseph sought to strengthen the Austrian Empire. To pacify a rebellious Hungary, he made Austria and Hungary autonomous states under a common sovereign in a "Dual Empire" – the Austro-Hungarian Empire. The system ignored the claims of other nationalist minorities in the Empire, including the Croatsians, Serbs, and Slovaks, fuelling tensions in Europe.

▽ **Franz Joseph** takes his oath of office in Budapest



1867 The US purchases
Alaska from Russia



1866-71

UNIFICATION OF GERMANY

In 1866, Prussian Chancellor Otto von Bismarck began removing the last obstacles to the unification of the various German states under Prussian rule. First, he engineered the Seven Week War (June–July 1866) with Austria. It left Austria isolated and weakened and Bismarck in control of a North German Confederation. Then, Prussian victory in the Franco-Prussian War (1870–71) neutralized the last opponent (France) to unification. On 18 January 1871, King Wilhelm IV of Prussia became Wilhelm I, Emperor of Germany.

◁ **Proclamation of the German Empire**